



Parks Commission Recreation - Report 3/11/2026

Dunbar Community Center

Youth Programs

- **Star Student:** school was out two days this month

Youth Athletics

- **Basketball & Cheer:** Dunbar Hawks competed in 6U–10U divisions. Finished with one league runner up place and 2 tournament championships.
- Soccer registration is closed
- Baseball registration is open

Upcoming - Special Events

- Black history program – Feb. 18 (Free)
- Bowling alley outing – Feb. 24 (\$10 for shoes and one game)

Facility Improvements (Planned)

- Waiting on score table to be delivered (ordered last year)
- Work order in to rehang items
- Quotes coming in for signage

Southwest Community Center

Youth Programs

- **Youth Dance Class** took a break for the month and is scheduled to resume in March. Schedule: Tuesdays & Thursdays, 5:30–6:30 p.m. Monthly Fee: \$10 per participant
- **Wednesday Art Night** continues to be offered weekly from 6pm-8pm through monthly membership. Staff are preparing for February's Free Art Night which featured a Pan-African Suncatcher Workshop honoring Black History Month on 2/4/25 at 6pm.
- **After-school & Youth Engagement:** Youth participation remains steady numbers being low but we are working daily to increase numbers by offer new ideas, programs and materials through supervised open play and recreation
- **Homeschool Recreation Hour:** Awaiting program approval receiving members and guest suggestions through our new suggestion box. Schedule: Tuesdays & Thursdays, 5:30–6:30 p.m. Monthly Fee: \$10 per participant.

Youth Athletics

- **Youth Basketball and Cheer:** The 10u and 12u Panther teams have officially wrapped their seasons with strong finishes. The 10u team secured 1st place in the league standings and 2nd place in the tournament play, the 12u team finished 2nd in the league. The 8u and 6u teams played in tournament, also. Cheerleaders continue practicing supporting teams. A volunteer cheer coach is currently completing the background check process.
- **Soccer** Registration closed this past week with SWCC successfully forming 4u, 8u, 10u, and 12u Panther teams. Saturday Skills and Drills sessions continue at 3pm, focusing on fundamental development. (16 registered)

- **Baseball** registration officially opened this week, with outreach underway to previous participants to encourage returning players (5 registered)

Adult Fitness Programs

- **Southwest Steppers Dance Workout Class:** are back in full swing for the year 2026. Planning for the Dancing at Dusk event, which is anticipated to take place at the River Market. Dates have been selected, waiting for location confirmation.
- **Walking Club** (Members and guest will experience the enjoyment of walking the trails at Southwest Community Center with a staff member miles will be recorded and incentives received periodically.
- **Yoga Class:** Waiting approval to advertise the position (Several instructors have been contacted)
- **Low-Impact Senior Workout:** A video-based program serving approximately 15 members and guests aged 65yrs and older.
- **Pickleball:** Beginners Thursday mornings 9:00 am-10:00 am.

Special Events & Community Outreach

- **Junior Botanist Program:** Working to relaunch the program at full capacity; exploring partnerships and resource needs. Game Room Social Hour, Awaiting program approval, Homeschool Recreation Hour
- **Black History Program** February 28th 2:00p.m. (Live Wax Museum) (Free Event registration required). This event strengthened community engagement, increased center visibility, and promoted ongoing programming.

Stephens Community Center

- **Outreach:** The school is back in the gym and their Basketball team practicing on Thursday from 3-4 pm.
- **Activities:** Fat Tuesday youth made King Cakes, Parents Night Out, and a Field Trip to the Mosaic Templars Cultural Center.
- **Star Student Afterschool Program:** There are 29 registered participants (58%).
- **Youth Sports Program:** Youth Basketball (2 teams), Soccer, and Cheerleaders (30 participants).
- **Adult Activities:** We have seniors that are coming 4 days a week. Preparing for the 40 & over Men's League.
- **Facility Vacancies:** 2-Part-Time Custodians or 1-Full Time Custodian.
- **Maintenance:** The ducts to the Air Unit have been repaired. Fire Alarm Control Panel reads Normal.

West Central Community Center

- **Youth Sports:** Basketball season has ended- 196 total participants, Soccer season has started- 46 total participants
- **Programs:** Karate program- 4 participants; Dance program- 2 participants; Black History program- 150 participants
Hosted QT4 ParkStat meeting
- **Meetings:** 20 meetings held in February
- **Rentals:** 5 rentals in February
- **Maintenance:** Parking lot lighting repairs underway.
- **Staffing:** Evening receptionist and one activity assistant have started. Another activity assistant will start in March. Recreation Programmer position is being processed.

ELR Community Center

- **Training:** Staff completing cybersecurity, First Aid/AED, Summer Hire and safety training.
- **Community Use:** Estem Athletics, Grounds, Outdoor courts and park areas used 3–5 days/week for recreation, trainings, and fitness.
- **Maintenance:** Grounds upkeep ongoing; tennis courts in need of refurbishment.
- **Meetings:** Mobile Market, PARK STAT, Senior Affairs informational, Work Order, Neighborhood meeting held with 19 attendees; next meeting March. 9.

Senior Programs: Active and Aging

- **Enrollment:** ALL sites continue to hold their 2026 Enrollment.
- **Community Outreach:** Baptist Health held their monthly outreach, monthly health screening and food distributions (Dunbar/East LR & Southwest).
- **Programs:** Dunbar, East LR, Southwest and West Central had their Valentine's and Black History, Southwest Annual King and Queen during their Valentine program. West Central hosted AARP Drivers Ed course on Feb. 23
- **Monthly Activities:** Chair volleyball, bean bag baseball, Birthday celebrations, Bingo/connect bingo, Bean Bag Baseball, Pickle Ball, Dominoes, Arts & Crafts, Guest Speakers, Weekly Field Trips, Bible Study, bowling, painting, Line Dancing, Mind Bending, Ring Toss, Silver Foxes Dance Class, Senior Chair Fitness, walking club, Quilting, Puzzles, Adult Coloring, Jewelry & T-Shirt Making, Skip-Bo, Card/Table Games, and Free play

Therapeutic Recreation

- **Enrollment:** Branch Out Adult Day Program... Full enrollment- 21 registered
- **Volunteer Service:** The TR Branch Out Volunteer Crew hosted the Annual TR Parks Appreciation Superbowl Taco Party on Thursday, Feb. 5th. We had approximately 40 Parks department staff to attend.
The TR staff took participants to Ballet Arkansas: Cinderella production on Sat., February 21st.
- **Special Annual Events:** On Thursday February 26 the TR staff, participants, park staff, and volunteers opened boxes of marathon medals and hung them on the stands for distribution on marathon days.
TR participants participated in the All-Abilities Marathon- Feb. 28: 30 registered. They did their final mile crossed the finish line to earn their official Little Rock Marathon medal!!

Looking Ahead:

- Under the Stars Prom event hosted by Fellowship Bible Church: Embrace Special Needs Program; March 3rd and March 10th. This is an annual event for special needs adults and serves hundreds of attendees.
- Little Rock Zoo-Thursday, March 5th
- Old Washington State Park: March 13: 16 registered
- Hot Springs-Garvan Woodland Gardens-March 19: 21 registered

Jim Dailey Fitness & Aquatics

- **Awards:** JDF&A has been nominated by AY Magazine as one of the best fitness gyms.
- **Fitness Programs:** The Commit to Fit 6-Week Challenge continues to progress successfully, 65 people registered and we are approaching the final phase of the program
- **Aquatics Programs:** The aquatics program continues to offer **7 classes** which includes one new: Aqua Fit on Wednesdays at 6:00pm.
- **Memberships/Revenue/Attendance:**

Memberships – 2,700 new memberships 676
Revenue -\$500,000.00 in total revenue 84,499.00
Attendance – 150,000 total in attendance 11,522 Report at the end of each month

The Centre at University Park (Currently Under Renovation)

Youth Athletics

- **Basketball:** season concluded Feb. 24th crowning 6 different division champions. There were 422 participants.
- **Indoor Soccer:** registration is closed, schedule being formulated
- **Baseball** registration is open.
- **All Youth Sports Numbers**
Basketball: Dunbar: 153; Southwest: 50; Stephens: 23; West Central: 196....**Total:** 422
Soccer: Dunbar: 31; Southwest: 22; Stephens: 25; West Central: 46....**Total:** 124

Adult Athletics

- **Interstate Park Program:** LRKA kickball club will kick off March 8, 2026 at fields 1, 4, 6 for 8 weeks. Adult softball league looking to start on April 6, 2026 with the coed league on Mondays and the women and men on Tuesday and Thursday.
- **Adult Basketball Program:** The 40 and over basketball league registration will begin on March 1, 2026 and will be played at Stephens community center The registration for the spring softball league opened up on January 15, 2026.
- **Summer Playground Program:** Planning has already begun for the summer of 2026 already secured dates for the main event and the LR Zoo.
- **Allsop Park:** Allsop ball field has been rented for all dates in March 2026
- **Kanis Park:** Arkansas Baptist continues the usage of Kanis park for baseball practice.

Rebsamen and First Tee Golf

- **Maintenance:** The grass sod farm is coming along very well and should be ready by spring to help replace some of the damaged tee boxes. Driving ranges are good shape.
- **Looking Ahead:** In 2026, both courses will significantly reduce purchasing of high-ticket items.

Rebsamen Tennis

- **Received:** \$70,000 in grant money from USTA, STA, and ATA to help pay for court surfacing project
- **Looking Ahead:** Over 60 teams signed up to play USTA Team Tennis at Rebsamen this Spring, play began in mid-February
- **Impact:** Facility was unable to be used from Jan 23 – Feb 6 due to the snowstorm
- **Tournament:** first of the year, small adult tournament, scheduled for Feb 27-March 1
- **Events:** Both academies are now back in full swing now that weather is turning
- **Looking Ahead:** Rebsamen-specific singles and doubles leagues begin March 2

Museum of Arkansas Military History

- **Attendance:** 1,617 for February (from 24 states including Arkansas)
- **Programs:** 165th anniversary of the Little Rock Arsenal Crisis, Afterschool (Dunbar, Stephens, & JA Fair, Vintage Military Gear Show (featured in *Arkansas Democrat-Gazette*), West LR Rotary Club, Officers Candidate School at Camp Robinson, Gibbs Elementary, Life Christian Academy

- **Gift Shop Sales:** \$610.39 (February) (February) YTD Total: \$1,266.72
- **Fundraising:** \$1,665 (February) YTD Total: \$6,785.75
- **Exhibits:** *Thomas Hart Benton*
- **Movies MacArthur:** *Black Patriots: Buffalo Soldiers* (Feb. 17), Upcoming: *The Donut Dollies: 627 Women Who Also Served in Vietnam* on March 17
- **Partnerships:** Freedom Sings America website: <https://www.freedomsingsarkansas.org/>
- **Museum Commissioner:** Helen T. Leigh (passed away Fe. 6)

Looking Ahead:

- March 7 – *French Arkansas*, Dr. Nate Marvin, Francophonie Festival, 2 pm
- March 12 - *Revolutionary Warfare: How the Algerian War Made Modern Counterinsurgency*, Dr. Terrence G. Peterson, 6 – 7:30 pm
- March 17 – Movies at MacArthur, *The Donut Dollies: 627 Women Who Also Served in Vietnam*, 6:30 – 8 pm
- March 24 – “An Evening with Curt Fields as General Ulysses S. Grant,” 7 – 9 pm
- March 25 – “An Evening with Curt Fields as President Grant,” 7 – 9 pm
- April 12 – “An Afternoon with Katie Hastert,” administrator of the Thomas Hart Benton Home and Studio State Historic Site, 2 pm
- April 21 – Movies at MacArthur, *Fighting Spirit: A Combat Chaplain’s Journey*, 6:30 – 8 pm

Outdoor Recreation

- **Registration:** 2026 Squatch Till You Drop trail running event opened on 2/10/26. 9 participants have already signed up.
- **Programs:** Had a discussion about adding kayaks and road bikes to Outdoor Recreation program offering.
Mountain Bike Rides: Tuesdays and Thursdays at Allsopp Park, north. Free program.
 Additionally: 70 dates added to the Outdoor Recreation calendar on Facebook and will be added to the Outlook calendar
- **Trainings:** cyber security and safety trainings